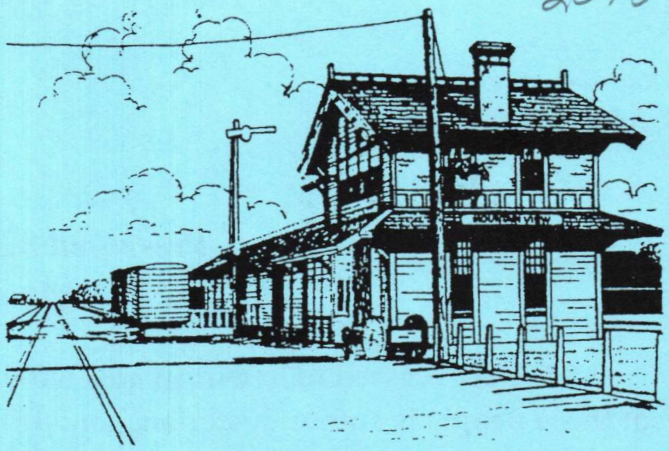
2010

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE:

By Honor Spitz

PLEASE CHECK YOUR MAILING LABEL TO SEE IF YOUR DUES ARE OVERDUE
(If you are two years in arrears, you will be dropped from our mailing list)

Someone far wiser than I was quoted once as having said, "Every end is a new beginning." As I've struggled the past few months with an elegant way in which to announce my "early retirement" as President of the Mountain View Historical Association, I couldn't find anything that said it better than that. While I have known for some time that I would be moving within the next year, I hadn't expected all of the pieces to fall into place as quickly as they have. I had fully intended and hoped to serve out my term, but now I will be handing off the baton much sooner than anticipated.

There have been some noteworthy events in the past year and a half in which I have been President. While I cannot take direct credit for any of them, I am nonetheless very proud. Most exciting, of course, is the status of the History Museum. The tireless and expert work of Bob Weaver and Nick Galiotto has paid off, and we are now ready to go forward with the fund raising campaign. Membership has increased, and we have begun to see new interest in the association due to our advertising in the "Preview" publication, as well as our wonderful up-to-date website created and maintained by Suzette Spencer. The Chamber of Commerce has taken note of the MVHA and become a valuable ally, giving us lots of "air time" on their "I Love MV" website as well.

When I think about my association with the MVHA, I am flooded with a myriad of thoughts and memories too great to mention specifically or in detail. However, if I were to narrow down the list and sum up my thoughts, I would say: friendship, respect and support, generosity, and connection to the community. Topmost would be, of course, all of the stories that so many of you have shared with me personally as well as putting your memories down in writing for the enjoyment and edification of future generations. Thank you from the bottom of my heart for everything!

2010

MAY SPEAKER:

By Bob Weaver

Presented byDon McDonald
May 2, 2010

We are blessed to live in an area with an abundance of truly remarkable people. One of those people is author, historian, good friend and our May speaker, Don Mc Donald. Most of us already know Don as a regular attendee of our meetings, and on Tuesdays you can most likely find him in our History Center doing research. What you may not know is that Don has just published a book on the History of Los Altos. In doing the research for his new book, Don uncovered many interesting facts and stories about Los Altos and the surrounding area, which he will share with us in his entertaining manner. Don has agreed to make this a book signing opportunity as well, so please come prepared. The cost of a first edition, inscribed by the author is only $21.99 plus sales tax. Mark your calendar for Sunday, May 2.

VOTE ON BYLAW AMENDMENTS: We will be voting on the Bylaw amendments at this meeting. Please read the Bylaws at the back of this newsletter.

MARK YOUR CALENDARS – UPCOMING EVENTS

By Bob Weaver

August BBQ

Our annual BBQ in August is always a treat, with zesty hamburgers, good friends, lively discussions and surprises. Last year we brought back Linda's Parisian Burgers so your taste buds could cruise down El Camino Real one more time. This year we have another treat for you. I have arranged for a surprise speaker who will captivate us with stories from California's past. We will hear stories of a very remarkable woman, the Pickering Redwood Grove and our State Flag to name a few. Sunday, August 1, save the date.

November Elections

This November, just like our country, the Mountain View Historical Association will be looking for new leadership as we hold our bi-annual elections. Our Association is a dynamic force in the Mountain View community, moving forward with the History Museum & Education Center, our most ambitious undertaking in over 50 years. We need people on our board that will continue the progress we have made, and lead us on to the next level. If you believe that Mountain View is a wonderful and dynamic city, then you must also believe that its history is worthy of celebrating as well. This may not be your

hometown but it is your children's. What will they know of it if you don't get involved now? Make your stand for Mountain View, Sunday, November 7.

History Museum Update

By Bob Weaver

May is California Museums Month. We have many fine museums in our area just waiting for your visit, and soon we will have one of our own here in Mountain View.

During the last several months we have made great headway with our History Museum. We have invested in software to help create a solid business plan that we will utilize in our Capital Campaign. The business plan is a document that outlines the groundwork for, and creates a path to, the successful development and operation of the History Museum.

I attended the California Association of Museums conference in March, which was held in San Jose. Their programs and lectures provided information that will open many doors for us within the museum community. Information regarding new products and services currently available has proven invaluable. I was able to network with representatives from other museums who have gone down the path we are currently on, and gained insight from their journeys. I met with representatives of companies that provide material and other support for museums, and came away with many new and exciting ideas that may be incorporated into our own History Museum.

Also, a meeting was held with representatives of John Viscovich's family to formulate a plan on how best to move the historic "Goose Neck" wagon and windmill, which John so generously donated to our museum, from John's property to our storage container, where they will reside with other historic memorabilia until our museum opens. The storage container is being prepared to accept and properly store those items selected for our museum, prior to the museum's opening. Tom Erichsen, Ruth & Wallace's son, spent a Saturday morning cutting holes and installing vents to accept the solar-powered ventilation system we will be installing in the container. Tom is also fabricating the mounting fixture for the two solar panels to be placed on the roof of the container. He is doing a great job and we deeply appreciate his time and talent.

The Mountain View Firefighters Local 1965 has given us a strong show of support with their generous donation of $800 to cover the cost of the solar vent system and the new paint for the exterior of the container. Not only will Local 1965 be paying for the paint, they will be painting the storage container for us as well! Many thanks to our own Cliff Del Carlo, Battalion Chief, who facilitated the deal, and to the men and women of Mountain View Firefighters Local 1965 for their very generous support of our project.

NEW TO THE LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

Submitted by Barbara Kinchen

Thank you to the Los Altos Chapter of the Daughters of the American Revolution (D.A.R.), and especially Ellen Osborn, Dorothy Demange, Roberta Kure and Shiela Mahler for producing and donating a copy of their new book, "Mountain View Cemetery, Pioneer Park, Mountain View, California." Contents of the over 200 page book cover history of the site, records of burials, removals, pictures of tombstones, newspaper articles and maps.

From author, Mrs. Margaret Beltran Duran, a 34 page booklet about a house she lived in during the 1950s with her parents, sisters and brother. The large, elaborate home stood just off El Camino until the 1960s and today it would stand behind the present Chevy's Restaurant. Mrs. Duran calls the house "Oakwood Hall, the Duran Estate's Not Quite Forgotten House and Ranch in Mountain View." The book includes photographs, maps, drawings, and descriptions of the home bought by J. T. Dunn in 1892. The research about the land and house is remarkable, covering history back to the Spanish land grant period and through the development into commercial property.

MVHA'S INCOME & EXPENSE STATEMENT

Beginning balance as of 8/07/2009:	$11,511.64
Income:	1,577.82
Expenses:	(2,714.76)
Ending balance as of 3/23/2010:	$10,374.70

MYSTERY SOLVED

Submitted by Barbara Kinchen

Both Rose Bautista Denzer and Frances Rodrigo Trimmer have sent information about the midget lady who was in noted in the last Newsletter. Her name was Mrs. Viola Fernandez and she lived on Dana Street. She had a daughter, Joan, and there might have been a son, John. Frances described her "as full of energy, busy, friendly, entertaining and even mischievous."

MEMBERSHIP

Submited by June Casey

Honored Members	**2**	
Life Members	**117**	
A/F Members	**72**	
A/S Members	**105**	
Total Members:		**296**

New A/S Members: Jean Nelms, Louise Jordan Rockhold and Louise Varma.

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association. Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION / RENEWAL FORM

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

Type (check one): New _____ Renewal _____

Regular Member $10/year

Family Membership $15/year

Life Time Member $200

Please make check payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

I REMEMBER: MEMORIES OF MOUNTAIN VIEW

(1) Submitted by Eugene Sharp

Motorcycle Police Officers and High School Students

Bob Taylor, MVUHS '49, told the following story, that he said originated with Paul McKim, MVUHS '46, at the MVUHS '48, '49, and '50 Class Reunion on Oct. 4, 2009.

Jeff Fitzgerald from Palo Alto liked to hang out around MVUHS. He drove a Model-T that had no license plates or muffler or things like that. Naturally, Motorcycle Officer Art Nielsen pulled him over, stopping between Lanes Creamery and the Spangler Mortuary during the lunch hour. All the guys gathered around to watch the action probably in 1945. While Nielsen was busy giving the ticket, some of the seniors put his motorcycle in the Mortuary.

After Nielsen had finished giving the ticket, his motorcycle was nowhere to be seen. Fitzgerald and Nielsen walked around the car looking for the motorcycle. Then Officer Nielsen marched into Principal Charles Crooke's office and asked for help. Mr. Crooke delivered a notice over the loud speaker system asking if anyone knew anything about the location of Officer Nielsen's Motorcycle. About this time Martin Spangler, who was President of the School Board, called to say that a motorcycle was leaking oil all over his garage floor.

Paul Nichols, MVUHS '46, remembers being stopped by Officer Nielsen and another much less qualified Police Officer at different times on Castro Street, when he was driving his '33 Plymouth.

(2) Submitted by Fern Wright McLaggan

I REMEMBER MY GRANDMOTHER'S HOUSES

It was the year 1916, when my Grandpa and Grandma, John Lloyd and Lillian Tidrow Wright, brought their four children from Paso Robles, California to Mountain View, California, to live in the house on the corner of California and Oak Street. The two story house was on a large corner lot which included a chicken coop, a large brown shed/garage and several trees (one being a special large fig tree). The house consisted of three bedrooms, two upstairs and one on the first floor, as well as a dining room, living room and a very large kitchen with a pantry. The kitchen had a large stove and several chairs for visiting with company, a hooked rug and several quilts. The bathroom was on the back screen porch.

My parents and I moved into Grandma and Grandpa's house when I was three years old because Grandpa was quite ill and Mother was needed to assist in his care. Grandma helped me gather the eggs from the chicken coop and I became friends with all the neighbors. I was told that Grandpa really enjoyed having me around and called me "bright eyes." He passed away while we lived there.

Several years after Grandpa passed away, the house became too large for Grandma to take care of, so my Uncle and Aunt bought the house from her. Grandma then moved into the Tank House on California Street. This was a fascinating house to me because it was small and tall and the best thing about it was that it was around the corner from the house where we lived.

Miss Bessie Bates lived next door to us and I was able to walk several times a day through her yard to my Grandma Wright's house. Grandma lived on the first floor which had a kitchen, bathroom and a living room/bedroom combination. Mr. Thompson, Grandma's boarder, lived upstairs. I loved this house and having Grandma living so close. I would help her cook and bake pies. She was a good cook and could make a special meal out of very little. Her big black stove/oven made me always think about the stove the witch had in the Hansel and Gretel story. The tank house still stands to this day and I always love driving by it and remembering those good times.

In 1957, Grandma's first house on the corner of Oak and California made headlines after a Jet plane from Moffett Field crashed into it. At the time, my Aunt and Uncle lived there. My Aunt was home at the time of the crash and had to climb out of the downstairs bedroom window. It is sad to me that that dear house is gone forever, but my memories are still alive.

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Honor Spitz, President -- Vivian Schatz, Vice President -- Margaret Peterson, Secretary -- Pat Figueroa, Treasurer

Bob Weaver, Past President -- Trudi Tuban, Newsletter Editor -- June Casey, Membership -- Bob Weaver, Programs & Publicity --

Laura Brown, Hospitality --Hip Telmont, Memorials & Remembrances -- Rick Espinosa, Ways & Means -- Barbara Kinchen,

Historical Data -- Al Jehning, Amplication & Recording

Mountain View Historical Association's

May 2, 2010 Meeting – 2PM

Speaker & Vote on Bylaws

"THE HISTORY OF LOS ALTOS"

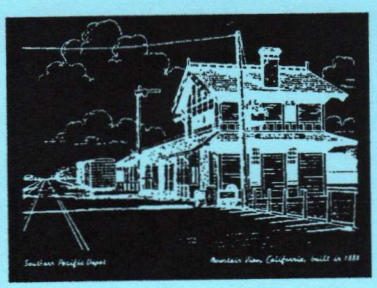
Presented by Don McDonald

Held at ***the Adobe Building***

At Moffett Blvd &

Central Expressway

Mountain View, CA



MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
BYLAWS

Approved - - - - - - - - - - , 2010



P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, Ca 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
BYLAWS

REVISED - - - - - - - - - - , 2010

ARTICLE 1 – NAME

Section 1. The name of this organization shall be MOUNTAIN VIEW PIONEER AND HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION.

ARTICLE II – AIMS

Section 1. The aims of this Association are to:

- Gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View;
- Collect, record, edit and publish a history of the development of this area;
- Preserve historic objects and places;
- Cooperate with other organizations in Santa Clara Valley on projects supported by our membership.

ARTICLE III – BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Section 1. The number of Directors shall be eleven (11).

ARTICLE IV MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. All persons who signify their interest in the aims of this Association and pay the specified annual dues shall constitute the members of this Association.

Section 2. Individuals or members who express their deep interest in this Association by a gift of the specified amount or more shall be declared life members and be free of further dues payments for life.

Section 3. The Executive Committee shall review all categories of membership ~~dues~~, submit for approval to the Board of Directors any proposed changes, ~~and~~ **which** may **be** change**d** ~~them if approved~~ **subject to approval** by a majority of the membership at the annual meeting.

Section 4. Honorary Membership shall be conferred upon an individual or business recommended by the Executive Committee and approved by the Board of Director**s**.

Section 5. Honored Membership has been conferred upon Miss Mercedes Castro (Sept. 1, 1870 – Apr. 30, 1965), daughter of Crisanto Castro. Honored membership was bestowed in recognition of her family's contribution to our community.

ARTICLE V – OFFICERS

Section 1: The officers of this Association shall be a President, Vice-President, Secretary and Treasurer.

ARTICLE VI – DUTIES OF OFFICERS

Section 1: The duties of officers shall be such as implied by their respective titles and as are specified in these Bylaws. Each officer shall keep accurate records of the work and turn them over to his/her successor.

Section 2. The President shall preside at all meetings of the Association, the Board of Directors and of the Executive Committee. He/she shall appoint ~~committee~~ Standing and Special **committees'** chairs subject to the ratification of the Board of Directors. The president shall be an ex-officio member of all committees, except the nominating committee.

Section 3. The Vice-President shall perform the duties of the President in his/her absence. In case of the death or resignation of the President, the Vice-President shall become President for the remainder of the term.

Section 4. The Secretary shall keep a correct and permanent record of the proceedings of all meetings of the Association and the Board of Directors; **shall keep copies of current Articles and Bylaws;** shall keep a list of the names and address of all members; shall, in case of the death or resignation of both the President and Vice-President, become the President until a President and Vice-President can be elected.

Section 5. The Treasurer shall receive all monies of the Association; keep an itemized account, in a permanent file, of all receipts and disbursements; present a written income and expense report at meetings of the Executive Committee, Board of Director meetings and for the Quarterly Newsletter; turn over to his/her successor, within ten days of vacating office, all books, records, papers and equipment including all data that is recorded on any electronic/digital medium accompanied by a hard copy of the same.

Section 6. If any officer, **director,** or standing committee chair fails to attend three **consecutive** meetings without adequate reason ~~or fails to cooperate on the program~~, such office or position may be declared vacant at the discretion of the ~~Executive Committee~~ **Board of Directors**.

ARTICLE VII - DUTIES OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS AND THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Section. 1.

(a) **The Board of Directors shall be composed of the four (4) elected officers, the immediate past president, the four (4) chairs of standing committees, and two (2) directors appointed by a Board majority of six (6) members.**

(b) The Executive Committee shall be composed of the **four (4)** elected officers **and** the immediate past president. ~~and the chairs of standing committees.~~

Section 2. The Board of Directors shall conduct the ~~routine~~ **ordinary** business of the Association; shall provide for at least four general membership meetings during the year and such other meetings as may seem necessary at the call of the President, or by five members of the Board of Directors; and shall ratify all appointments.

Section 3. The Executive Committee shall appoint an Auditing Committee annually by the end of the fiscal year (December 31.) The Auditing Committee shall be composed of three members of the Association and they shall submit a written report to the Board of Directors.

ARTICLE VIII – STANDING COMMITTEES

Section 1. There shall be the following standing committees:

Historical Data Newsletter Ways & Means Membership

Section 2. It shall be the duty of the **HISTORICAL DATA COMMITTEE** to cooperate with the Executive Committee in planning for the collection, recording, editing and publishing of historical data and in the program of preservation of historical objects and places.

Section 3. It shall be the duty of the **MEMBERSHIP COMMITTEE** to suggest ways and means to increase the membership; to stimulate the interest of the membership in the Association program; to solicit membership and collect dues; to keep an accurate record of the membership.

Section 4. It shall be the duty of the **NEWSLETTER COMMITTEE** to gather, edit, publish and distribute quarterly newsletters with content relevant to the purposes of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Section 5. It shall be the duty of the **WAYS AND MEANS COMMITTEE** to formulate plans for the raising of funds for special projects of the Association.

ARTICLE IX – NOMINATIONS AND ELECTIONS

Section 1. Officers shall be elected biennially in November. They shall assume their duties immediately following the adjournment of the Annual Meeting at which they are elected. Election shall be by majority vote.

Section 2. At the August meeting in an election year, **the President shall recommend** a nominating committee ~~shall be appointed~~ **for members' approval,** ~~who~~ **which** shall present to the annual meeting the nominees for each office. Nominations may also be made from the floor **at the annual meeting**.

Section 3. The President, with the approval of the ~~Executive Committee~~ **Board**, shall fill any vacancy occurring in one of the offices of the Association for the remainder of the term, except as provided in Article ~~V~~ **VI**, Section 3 and 4.

ARTICLE X – MEETINGS

Section 1. Regular membership meetings shall be held quarterly, in November, February, May and August, at ~~placed~~ **a location** decided upon by the Executive Committee. The date **or time** of a general membership meeting may be changed by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Committee.

ARTICLE XI – QUORUM

Section 1. Thirty (30) members shall constitute a quorum at any Association meeting. A majority of the members of the Board of Directors shall constitute a quorum of that body.

ARTICLE XII – DUES

Section 1. The annual dues for members shall be as prescribed by the Board of Directors, payable for the current year, in advance.

ARTICLE XIII– AMENDMENTS

Section 1. Amendments to the Bylaws may be made at any regular **or special noticed membership** meeting by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the members present, provided such amendments have been proposed at the preceding meeting and notice ~~mailed~~ **given** to each member at least ten days prior to the date of such meeting ~~before~~ **at which** the amendments are voted.

Section 2. Notice shall be given personally, by electronic transmission by the association, or by mail or other means of written communication, addressed to the member at the address of such member appearing on the books of the association or given by the member to the association for purpose of notice.

ARTICLE XIV– PARLIAMENTARY PROCEDURE

Section 1. 'ROBERT'S RULES OF ORDER, REVISED' shall govern this Association in all cases to which they are applicable and insofar as they are not inconsistent with these Bylaws.

ARTICLE XV – POLICY

Section 1. This Association shall be non-sectarian, non-profit and non-partisan.

End
#